

TREASURES OF THE WORLD

The Isfahan Star Bowl

Central Iran (Isfahan) • c. 1250 / Hammered brass with silver inlay

A broad ceremonial basin whose interior maps constellations around a dark eight-pointed star. The object first appears in a European collection in 1912. Its documented chain of ownership becomes incomplete between 1940 and 1978 before reappearing in a Swiss private collection. Sterling Voss acquired it in 1992. The Meridian has announced it as the centerpiece of Treasures of the World.

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Moon Jar Of Haeju

Korea • late 18th century / White-glazed porcelain

An unusually full-bodied white jar assembled from two thrown hemispheres. Slight asymmetry gives the vessel its quiet character. Loaned from the Voss Collection for the first time.

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Cedar & Cloud Screen

Japan • Edo period, c. 1740 / Ink, mineral pigment, and gold leaf on paper

A six-panel folding screen depicting cedar branches disappearing into bands of cloud. A collector's seal on the reverse links the screen to a Kyoto merchant family in the nineteenth century.

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Night Garden Album Leaf

Northern India • Mughal period, c. 1660 / Opaque watercolor and gold on paper

A moonlit garden scene populated by birds, flowering vines, and a single reading figure. The page was separated from a larger album before entering the European market.

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The Storyteller Goldweights

Ghana • 19th century / Cast brass

A set of small figurative weights made for measuring gold dust. Their forms encode proverbs about speech, patience, obligation, and reputation. The set is presented here as a study in art, commerce, and memory.

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Cusco Silver Writing Box

Peru • c. 1780 / Silver, cedar, and velvet

A portable writing box made in Cusco with repoussé floral ornament. Its compartments hold ink, paper, seals, and correspondence - the infrastructure of long-distance colonial administration.

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Laurel Krater

Southern Italy • 4th century BCE / Red-figure ceramic

A large mixing vessel decorated with laurel branches and two musicians. The museum label carefully notes that the vessel's modern ownership history begins only in 1968.

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Indigo Court Textile

Southwestern Nigeria • early 20th century / Indigo-dyed cotton

A large resist-dyed cloth whose repeating geometry shifts across the field rather than remaining perfectly regular. Displayed flat to emphasize both pattern and handwork.

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Study For Red Transit

Mariana Costa (Brazilian, b. 1978) • 2004 / Oil, wax, and graphite on linen

A contemporary painting of layered transit maps, erased routes, and blocks of red pigment. The work entered the Voss Collection shortly after the artist's first major international exhibition.

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The Voss Collection

The Meridian Museum of Art & World Cultures
Opening-night gala / October 30, 2026

An exhibition of art and culture from around the world. All objects and collection histories in this party kit are fictional.

- Star Bowl: thrift-store metallic bowl, decorative charger, or inexpensive brass-colored bowl on a black cloth or box pedestal.
- Moon Jar: any plain white vase or ceramic jar.
- Screen: folded foam board or trifold display board with a printed or hand-drawn branch motif.
- Album Leaf / Red Transit: print any public-domain-style decorative pattern or make abstract art on cardstock; the placard does most of the world-building.
- Goldweights: arrange inexpensive brass-colored charms, keys, or small metal objects in a shallow case.
- Writing Box: jewelry box, cigar-style craft box, or small wooden container.
- Krater: dark vase or urn with a printed decorative band taped around it.
- Indigo Textile: patterned blue fabric, scarf, table runner, or thrifted textile.
- Do not spend money trying to make every object literal. One convincing centerpiece plus museum lighting, labels, and room signs will sell the fiction.